

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes

MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, July 10, 2024, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne - Absent
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter – Absent
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden – Entered at 6:38 pm
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor William Greenrose
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges – Absent
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

Manager Manale requested to remove item J from new business.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to accept the minutes of the June 19, 2024, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 5-0

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to accept the minutes of the June 26, 2024, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

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Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 5-0

MAYOR'S NOTES

Eastern State Cup race is this weekend at Arrowhead Recreation.

National Night out is on August 6th, from 4pm to 7pm.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Manager Manale thanked the Council for a productive budget process, and noted the final increase of .27 to increase operating expenses, while other communities are up to 12%

Proactively seeking federal funds to enhance the City, successfully submitted the application to the US Department of Interior for Land and Water Conservation funding for the pickle ball and tennis courts, another project public meeting will be held once there is a finalized design.

Next week from July 17th to the 19th 12A bridge over the sugar river will be closed, a detour will be provided and message boards with notices will be displayed.

Fire Chief has updated that the signal project on Washington Street is nearing completion.

North Street project is a continuous effort, water line replacements are underway.

The City auction is being held on July 27th at CSBCC.

Manager Manale announced the cancelation of the July 24th City Council meeting, the next meeting will be August 14th.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Parks and Rec

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint John Simonds to Seat 5 – At Large of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

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Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 5-0

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Koloski to appoint Jeffery Coburn to Seat 7 – Ward III of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 5-0

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to appoint Eric Zengota to Seat 2 Ward II of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 5-0

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Sheila Rook to Alternate Seat 3-at large of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

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Girard – yes

Motion carried 5-0

Councilor Hayden – entered at 6:38 p.m.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to appoint Ken Burke to Seat 4 – At Large of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden- yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to appoint Courtney Porter to Alternate Seat 5 – At Large of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden- yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to appoint William Blewitt to Alternate Seat 6 – At Large of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden- yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Airport Advisory

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to re-appoint Paul Dube to Seat 3 – on the Airport Advisory Board.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden- yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Conservation Commission

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to appoint Joella Merchant to Seat A3 on the Conservation Commission.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden- yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Fiske Free Library

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to appoint Raymond Gagnon to Seat A-3 of the Fiske Free Library Board of Trustees.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

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Hemingway – yes

Hayden- yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Planning Board

A motion was made by Councilor Greenrose and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to appoint Maxime J. Guinel De France to Seat 6 of the Planning Board.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden- yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

CITIZEN’S FORUM

Mayor Girard gave reminder that Citizen’s forum is designed to allow you the opportunity to make the Council aware of your concerns. Please state your name and ward number, we ask you to address your concerns directly to the Council. The Council Manager will not be responding to you during this time. You are limited to five minutes on any non-agenda items. In the back of the room please write down your contact information if you’d like to be contacted as well as your concern on the clipboard for follow up.

Norm Blouin, Ward III, brought up concerns over the Department of Public Works mulcher, and also shared concern over the building next door. Mr. Blouin also stated he doesn’t think all of Washington needs to be paved, and has a concern for salt going into the sugar river.

OLD BUSINESS

Ordinance 630 Short Term Rentals

Manager Manale presented Ordinance 630, and stated this was to provide guidance for short

term rentals in the downtown area, as the city had previously treated these case by case, Director Merrill added, short term rentals were not permitted, and if anyone wanted one they had to apply to get a variance.

Assistant Mayor Matteau stated the planning board spent a lot of time discussing this, and thinks it's a good step forward.

Councilor Heminway had concerns about having too many short-term rentals in the community would cause problems.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Hayden to pass ordinance 630 to a second reading at the August 14th council meeting.

Assistant Mayor Matteau read the explanation of proposed action into record.

Councilor Hemingway stated he thinks Planning put the Ordinance together nicely, but wants to see the zoning reduced to commercial spaces, as he sees this as a detriment, also sharing concerns with thirty-day limits.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – no

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 5-1

Ordinance 629 2024 Non-Union Employee Merit Scale Plan Attachment C Adjustment

Manager Manale noted this is an increase to the Merit Scale with a 5% increase to the bottom and \$10,000.00 to the top.

Councilor Koloski recused himself from the vote.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to adopt Ordinance 629.

Councilor Hemingway read the explanation of proposed action into the record.

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Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 5-0

Ordinance 625, 2024 Non-Union Employee Classification Plan Attachment B- Business Development Coordinator/Deputy Director of Planning and Development

Manager Manale presented Ordinance 625 and noted creating this position would help business retention and recruitment, and day to day tasks in the department.

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to pass Ordinance 625 to a third and final reading on August 14th council meeting.

Councilor Hayden read the explanation of proposed action in the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Ordinance 627, 2024 Non-Union Employee Classification Plan Attachment B- City Treasurer – Second Reading

Manager Manale explained this is a grade change to retain a qualified individual.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to pass to a third and final reading at the August 14th meeting.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

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Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Ordinance 628, 2024 Non-Union Employee Classification Plan Attachment B- Chief Building Inspector and Health Officer – Second Reading

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to pass Ordinance 628 to a third and final reading at the August 14th council meeting

Councilor Koloski read explanation of proposed action into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

NEW BUSINESS

Ordinance 626, 2024 Non-Union Employee Classification Plan Attachment B- Part Time Evidence Custodian – First Reading

Chief Wilmot presented this position and is requesting to create a part time evidence custodian, at a grade 6 to help diffuse some work to free up detective staff.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to pass Ordinance 626 to a second reading at the August 14th council meeting.

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Mayor Girard opened up for public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

TAC Updates

Chief Wilmot noted the Traffic Advisory Committee is an advisory committee of the Council, and currently consists of voting members Chief Wilmot, Chief Chamberlain, Director Gleeson, whereas the City manager is an advisory member.

Chief Wilmot stated there are members of the public here who made a request to the Traffic Advisory Committee, for a crosswalk at the intersection of South Street and Highland Street- the Traffic Advisory Committee is not recommending this change due to guidance set through the Department of Transportation on crosswalks. Chief has met with these residents, and explained the rationale as to why it is not being recommended.

Chief Wilmot then read through other Traffic Advisory requests:

Broad Street re-design- several people have come before the TAC expressing their misgivings about the merge at Glidden/Broad Street intersection. Chief Wilmot along with Chief Chamberlain met with the Superintendent of schools and discussed moving student parking off of Broad Street and noted the BETA Group is currently doing additional work on new ideas for how we can re-tool that intersection.

Speed limit on Broad Street - is currently 20 miles per hour, and the recommendation is that the posting be changed to 30 miles per hour to comport with state law.

Spring Street – Claremont Learning Partnership- has added an ADA entrance in the back, on Spring Street at the apex of that road, there was a prior request to add a crosswalk there, a traffic count was done back in August 2022, based on this the TAC does not think this crosswalk is advisable. However, the Claremont Learning Center has added an ADA entrance and ramp to that area and reapproached the Traffic Advisory Committee. Chief Wilmont noted the owners have stated there have been several near misses and one recently in the back. The Traffic Advisory Committee with the guidance from NHDOT does not recommend a crosswalk but would recommend some sort of traffic calming devices to be placed temporarily on Spring Street.

Sullivan Street Cross Walk- A petition for a cross walk on Walnut Street was given to the Traffic Advisory Committee from Frances J Tolles Home members. They had concerns about speeding, Chief Wilmot added more Patrol, and a traffic Count will be done through the department of public works,

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but based on guidance from NHDOT the Traffic Advisory Committee would not recommend a crosswalk.

Another Petition came before the Traffic Advisory Committee from the Ivy League Neighborhood about paving in that neighborhood, Director Gleeson explained to them Infrastructure work was on-going and now complete.

Request for a cross walk at Glidden and Middle Street for pedestrians to safely access the bakery, but there is a crosswalk at Broad and Glidden, that and guidance from NHDOT, the TAC does not recommend a crosswalk.

Barber Street one way traffic- a traffic count was held in August of 2023, it was found that there is 660 vehicles that travel Barber Street from the direction of High Street towards Broad Street, there is 891 vehicles traveling from Broad Street to High Street. Chief Wilmot shared concern for vehicles parked on Barber Street by the Library, that it constricts the roadway to such a degree that two-way travel becomes dangerous. The recommendation from the TAC is to bring forward an Ordinance change to make Barber Street one way.

Council agrees to hear from resident Tina Pavlovich.

Tina Pavlovich Ward II, lives on Highland Ave., put in request for a crosswalk. Ms. Pavlovich stated her appreciation for the Chief explaining the reasoning why a crosswalk couldn't be put in.

Elizabeth Graham, Ward I, lived in the Barber St. area for twenty years, and has been concerned for this street since Broad Street was re-done, and expressed she would love to see Barber Street become one way.

Councilor Koloski would like to see this come back in draft form.

By Consensus City Council agrees to bring back a draft ordinance.

Request to Name City Owned Property

Chief Wilmot presented the request to re-name the Detective Division, and read his memo to the Council:

RE: Detective Division Naming

Dear Manager Manale and the Honorable City Council:

On December 28, 2023 Captain Colby D. Casey (ret.) passed away following a brief period of illness. At the time of his passing, Captain Casey was an active member of the Claremont Police Department, serving in a part-time capacity as an Investigator and Chief Recruitment Officer. Captain Casey also served as our Evidence Custodian, a role he filled for the past two decades. Captain Casey began working for the City of Claremont in 1992, and retired from full-time service in 2013.

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Captain Casey dedicated 31 years of his life in service to the citizens of Claremont, many of those years serving in the Detective Division as a juvenile detective, a major case detective, and then as the Commander in charge of the Division. Captain Casey's investigative acumen was second-to-none, and his skills, particularly in conducting interviews, were admired by his colleagues everywhere. He had an unmatched ability to communicate with anyone with whom he came into contact. In his 31 years of service, he was honored with numerous commendations and public recognition; including the Gallantry Star, Meritorious Service, Employee of the Year, and dozens of unit citations for a variety of exemplary actions. Captain Casey made a lasting impact on everyone with whom he worked, and embodied the spirit of a public servant, leaving an indelible mark on our department and the City of Claremont as a whole.

May 15, 2024 was National Peace Officer Memorial Day. Police Week and Peace Officers Memorial Day began by way of Presidential proclamation in 1962 with President John F. Kennedy. In his proclamation, President Kennedy asked that "the people of this nation join together in commemorating police officers, past and present, who by their faithful and loyal devotion to their responsibilities have rendered a dedicated service to their communities and, in so doing, have established for themselves an enviable and enduring reputation for preserving the rights and security of all citizens."

During the evening of Wednesday, May 15, a meeting of the Claremont Police Commission was held at the Atrium of the Opera House. At that meeting, the Claremont Police Department presented Captain Casey's widow, Terri, with a plaque honoring his service and dedicating the Detective Division, a room within the police department, in his name. Now, to formalize that process according to City Code, Chief Wilmot would like to make a presentation to the Honorable Claremont City Council, seeking their majority approval for the re-naming of the Claremont Police Department Detective Division to the Colby D. Casey Detective Division.

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Chapter 16, Article V of the Claremont City Code deals with the Naming of City-Owned Property. Section 16-110 vests the Claremont City Council with the sole designating authority for naming all city-owned property, and states that the decision on whether or not to name a specific city-owned building, park, trail, street, parking lot or other facility or property shall be by majority vote of the city council, after public hearing duly noticed. Further, all proposals to name or rename city-owned property located in the historic district should be considered for an opinion by the Historic District Commission prior to final consideration by the city council.

In this particular case, Chief Wilmot has received written notice from the Historic District Commission, that such formal approval will not be necessary. While the Claremont Police Department is located within the Historic District, formal approval for the naming of an interior room within a building does not need to go before the Commission. A copy of that letter has been appended to this memorandum.

Requests to name city-owned property may be made in writing by the mayor, assistant mayor, city councilor, city manager, city board, commission or committee or citizen, detailing how the proposal meets the criteria as set forth in the City Code. Being a citizen of the City of Claremont, and its Chief of Police, I am formally requesting this name change in writing. This written request is also being given with the full support of the Honorable Claremont Police Commission, who are signatories on this memorandum.

According to the City Code, Section 16-111, the following criteria for naming of city-owned property shall be considered by the city council in approving a request to name city-owned property, other than streets:

1. Context and geographical locations, reflecting the name in common use, function or significance of the property;
2. Natural or geological features of the property that are distinctive or physically prominent;
3. Historic significance that may be:
 - a. Associated with an event or series of related events in the city's history;
 - b. Associated with one (1) or more individuals who have played a significant role in the city's historic development or government;
 - c. Reflective of a distinctive artistic, scientific or literary achievement;
 - d. Related to an existing or proposed historic property or district designated or eligible to be designated as historic by either federal or state government.
4. Contributions to the city, including but not limited to:
 - a. An individual or organization that has made a significant direct contribution of property or of money for the construction and/or development of a city facility;
 - b. An individual's significant public service, whether as a private citizen or public servant; however, generally city-owned property will not be named after a deceased person until at least one (1) year after the date of death, except where, in the sole discretion of the city council, the individual's contribution merits immediate recognition.
 - c. A living person may be considered with a two-thirds vote of the city councilors present.

Captain Casey was a dedicated public servant, earnestly serving the City of Claremont for 31 years. His contributions to the Claremont Police Department and its mission will have positive impacts

on the residents, the employees of the city and the law enforcement profession for generations to come. For this reason, and the reasons listed at the opening of this memorandum, we are respectfully requesting that the Detective Division be formally re-named to the Colby D. Casey Detective Division.

While the City Code indicates that city-owned property will generally not be named after a deceased person until at least one (1) year after the date of death, it does provide for an exception, where in the sole discretion of the city council, the individual's contribution merits immediate recognition. Chief Wilmut would be honored to provide a presentation to the Claremont City Council, explaining the myriad reasons why the above-listed criteria have been met in furtherance of the re-naming of the Detective Division (room) in Captain Casey's name. Further, he would be willing to share why, in his opinion, the one year requirement can be waived in this instance, and the Detective Division can be re-named after only six months following Colby's untimely passing.

Motion to Name the Colby D. Casey Detective Division

The Claremont Police Department wishes to re-name the Detective Division, contained within the Claremont Police Station, to the Colby D. Casey Detective Division. The request has been reviewed by the Claremont Historic District Commission (as the Police department is located within the Historic District), and due to the fact that the proposed alterations (a plaque bearing his name, erected adjacent to the door) are entirely within the building, prior approval from the HDC is not required. Furthermore, the request to re-name this room comports with Claremont City Code, Chapter 16, Article V (Naming of City-Owned Property). Therefore, the Claremont City Council hereby authorizes the Chief of Police to re-name the Detective Division to the Colby D. Casey Detective Division.

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A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to Name the Colby D. Casey Detective Division

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Resolution 2025-6 Bryne Foundation Grant – Public Hearing

Director Martin explained the Bryne Foundation Grant and the receiving of 19 youth helmets.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept resolution 2025-6.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Director Martin- thanked assistant director Shaun Laplante for going after this grant.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Tax Deeded Properties (City Manager/City Clerk)

Manager Manale and City Clerk, Gwen Melcher explained the original motion was discussed back in October. The City worked with Sugar River Co-op to purchase 18 Upham Place, and will sell to them for back taxes.

Motion to Authorize Sale of City-Owned Property

The Claremont City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager, or his designees, to transfer title of a city owned mobile home, acquired by Tax Collector's Deed, located at 18 Upham Pl, Tax Map 159, Lot 56-22, to Sugar River Cooperative, Inc of 40 Upham Pl, Claremont, NH for taxes due at the time of deeding which was \$9,675.02.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to authorize sale of city owned property.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Councilor Koloski requested to read the original motion.

Motion to Sell Property Acquired by Tax Deed

The Claremont City Council, pursuant to RSA 80:80, hereby authorizes the City Manager, or his designees, to transfer title to real estate acquired by the City by tax collectors deed for nonpayment of taxes by public auction at the following addresses:

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1 CLEARY CT

20 DENNISON AVE

342 EAST GREEN MOUNTAIN RD

27 ELM ST

9 FIRST ST

11 FIRST ST

20 GOYETTE AVE

LAFAYETTE ST

LAFAYETTE ST

32 LAFAYETTE ST

12 LEA ST

166 MAIN ST - merging w/107-48

170 MAIN ST - merging w/107-47

74 MAPLE AVE

58 PEARL ST

159 PLEASANT ST

157 PLEASANT ST

19 WALNUT ST

150 WHITEWATER BROOK RD

60 CENTRAL ST

NORTH ST

111 MAIN ST

119 MAIN ST

ELM ST, map/lot 107-247

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The City Council authorizes the City Manager or his designees to undertake all such actions as may be required to implement this motion.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to sell property acquired by tax deed.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Ordinance 631 Elderly Tax Exemption – First Reading

Assessor, Stephen Hamilton explained Ordinance 631 adjusts the qualification of income and assets of applicant amount for elderly exemption.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to pass Ordinance 631 to a second reading at the august 14th meeting.

Councilor Koloski read the explanation of proposed action into record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Ordinance 632 Disabled Tax Exemption – First Reading

Assessor, Stephen Hamilton also explained the Disabled Tax exemption and how it is different from the elderly exemption. The elderly exemption program is required in statute, every community must grant the elderly exemption program. Its up to the community how much to grant in that exemption amount, and the qualification standards. The disability exemption is optional, only 111 of the 259 taxing jurisdictions in New Hampshire have adopted the disability exemption program, but only 89 of the communities grant any disability according to last years figures provided by the DRA.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to pass Ordinance 631 to a second reading at the august 14th meeting.

Councilor Hemingway read the explanation of proposed action into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing.

Elizabeth Graham, Ward I, stated she is an advocate for the disabled in our community and thanked the Council for bringing this to a vote.

Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Resolution 2025-7 Washington Street Bond – Public Hearing

Manager Manale stated this should be motion not a resolution as the Council is being asked to authorize the City Manager or designee to pursue a bond for Washington St, not approving the bond as we don't know what the interest rate is.

Finance director, Bates noted the application would be due in October which means the finance

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office would have to start working with bond council now, and then would come back with a bond resolution for the Council to vote on.

A motion was made by Councilor Greenrose and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to authorize the city manager or his designees to pursue work with Bond Council amended up to 1,246,430.00 million for the Washington Street Paving Project.

Councilor Koloski not comfortable with not specifying a dollar amount, and wants a dollar amount in the motion.

Councilor Greenrose and Assistant Mayor Matteau are okay with that change.

Councilor Koloski stated he can't support this amount and wants the Bowen intersection backed out of the amount.

Mayor Girard shared concerns about the fund balance.

Manager Manale understands the concerns about fund balance, but reassured the City has spoken to auditors and DRA they also feel comfortable with the amount we could be taking out.

Councilor Hemingway asked how soon do we have to start working to get the bond for October. Director Bates stated right away.

Assistant Mayor Matteau is concerned about losing the bid price, and would hate to see it increase due to inflation.

Assistant Mayor Matteau stated the need to go through a couple of things. One, would be to start the bond work adding there is nothing to lose by starting to work with the Bond Council, but there is a timeline involved and the Council still has authority to say yay or nay. Assistant Mayor Matteau doesn't think the Council should close this door. Number two, is whether the Council wants to keep current bid and do fund balance and keep Bowen Street intersection or not, but doesn't think this part needs to be decided on tonight. Assistant Mayor Matteau suggested the City Manager ask the current bidder to take Bowen out and have DPW come back to tell us their recommendation.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one Spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Resolution 2025-8 Fund Balance Transfer

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to table Resolution 2025-8 until City staff has information from the audit and an amended potential bid.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

COMMITTEE REPORTS

None.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Mayor Girard added a future directive for a joint meeting in September With the School Board.

Councilor Koloski asked what the expectation of attendance for council members are.

Assistant Mayor Matteau stated the need to hold members accountable unless there is valid reason not to be in attendance

Councilor Koloski suggested looking at other communities and maybe an adoption to council rules.

Councilor Koloski shared a concern for a trip to Iceland promoted through Parks and Recreation.

Assistant Mayor Matteau would like an update on the rental of the community center's main gymnasium and what the city got for revenue for the Reel Steel Boxing event.

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:34 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to adjourn.

Voice Vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 6-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council